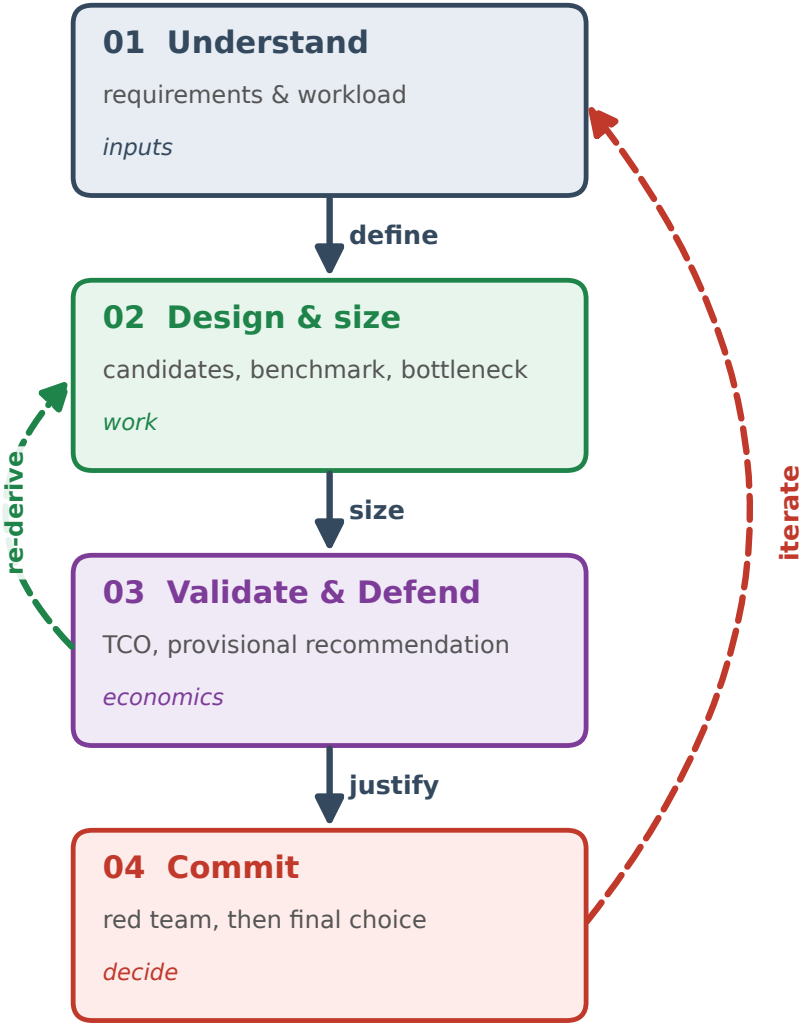The architect's decision loop